

Permit Coverage & Inspections Reference

What each permit covers, and what still requires a separate permit

Part 1 — What Each Permit Covers

Use this to answer “is that included, or do I need a separate permit?” at the counter. The key rule throughout: the building/structure permit covers the structure; the trades (electrical, plumbing, mechanical, gas) almost always need their own separate permits.

Permit	Covers	Does NOT Cover
New Construction (Building Permit)	The structural shell — foundation, framing, exterior walls, structural roof framing, AND the roof covering. Roofing is included when installed as part of new construction.	Electrical, plumbing, HVAC/mechanical, gas — each requires its own trade permit.
Electrical	Wiring, panel, and connections for the specific scope listed (new service, upgrade, outlets/switches, solar, or generator).	The structure itself. A generator also needs a separate Gas permit if propane- or natural-gas-fed.
Renovations (Plumbing / Gas / Mechanical / Windows & Siding)	The specific trade work listed.	Structural changes to accommodate it (altering load-bearing walls) — that needs a separate building permit too.
Mobile Home Set-Up	Blocking, anchoring, and tie-down inspection ONLY.	Electrical hookup (separate Residential Electrical permit) and plumbing/septic connection — septic is permitted by the Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP), never the Health Department.
Roofing Permit	Re-roofing and roof repair on an EXISTING structure only, priced by square footage.	Roofing on new construction — that's included in the New Construction permit. Never charge a separate roofing fee for a brand-new building's roof.
Accessory Buildings (formerly Pole Barn / Shed)	The structure itself.	Any plumbing inside (a septic permit from the Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) is required — not the Health Department) and any electrical (separate Electrical permit).
Comprehensive Plan Review (Site Plan, etc.)	Approval of the land use and site layout — setbacks, parking, drainage.	A building permit. Site plan approval does NOT substitute for the building permit required before construction.
Swimming Pool	The pool structure and required safety barrier.	Electrical bonding/wiring — separate Electrical permit, and by law (FS 489.103(6)) must be done by a licensed contractor. No owner-builder exception for pools.
Decks and Ramps	The structure itself.	Any electrical (outdoor lighting, outlets) — separate Electrical permit.

Part 1b — When NO Permit Is Required (HB 803, effective July 1, 2026)

Two exemptions let work proceed with no permit at all. Both are narrow — confirm every condition before waiving a permit.

The \$7,500 cosmetic exemption. Strictly cosmetic, non-structural work on a single-family home with a total declared value under \$7,500 — flooring, cabinets, painting, drywall finishing. It does NOT apply to electrical, plumbing, mechanical, gas, or structural work at ANY value, and is VOID if the property is in a designated flood hazard area. Splitting a project to stay under the threshold is prohibited. A signed Written Request for Exemption (HB 803) must be submitted before work begins.

Temporary hurricane / flood walls. A separate exemption with no dollar threshold, for a temporary residential hurricane or flood wall meeting the specified standards. Confirm the applicable standard with the Building Official before waiving a permit.

Part 2 — Inspections

The following inspection requirements are what is currently documented in the department's permit materials. They are NOT a complete inspection sequence — see the gap note below.

Documented Inspections

- **Mobile Home Set-Up:** the block, anchor, and tie-down inspection (this is the entirety of what the \$300 set-up permit covers).
 - **Roofing (third-party path):** roof deck nailing and/or secondary water barrier, verified by a licensed third-party inspector via the Roof Inspection Affidavit, with photographs of each plane of the roof showing the permit number or property address.
 - **New Construction — first inspection:** a first inspection exists and cannot be scheduled until the Notice of Commencement has been recorded with the Clerk of Court and posted on the job site (required when job value exceeds \$2,500).
 - **New Construction — final inspection:** required before a Certificate of Occupancy is issued. A confirmed 911 address must also be on file before the CO.
-
- **Inspection Fees**
 - **Additional Inspection:** \$50.00
 - **Re-Inspection:** \$50.00 (first re-inspection free)

Both fees are in the current fee schedule. An additional inspection is one beyond those included with the permit type.

Known Gap — No Documented Inspection Sequence

There is currently no documented, step-by-step inspection sequence for a standard permit — e.g., the order and count of inspections a typical house requires (footing, slab, framing, rough-in for each trade, insulation, final), which trades trigger which inspections, and what must pass before the next stage can proceed.

This information does not appear in any of the department's written materials shared to date. It may currently live only with the building official rather than in a document.

This is tracked as an open item. Documenting the actual inspection sequence is also a prerequisite for costing inspection fees accurately, since the fee should reflect how many inspection trips each permit type genuinely requires.

Part 1 (coverage) is settled guidance. Part 2 (inspections) reflects only what is currently documented — the sequence gap must be filled by the building official before this section is complete.